



Mi-Cam easily hackable

Popular baby monitor Mi-Cam by miSafes has been found to be susceptible to critical security vulnerabilities.
<http://digit.in/miSafeNoMo>



More Amazon Go

Amazon's automated convenience store Amazon Go is set to open six more outlets this year.
<http://digit.in/6MoreAmazonGo>

Armed and Dangerous

Firearms have played a crucial role in shaping the world that we know today, but how much do we know about their history?

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or as long as human civilisation has existed, there has been a need to attack others for what they

have that we want. To help us do so, we've constantly made new and improved ways of killing one another. Here's the terrible history of our violence with firearms.

GUNPOWDER

Although still widely debated, the popular opinion amongst historians is that gunpowder originated in China in the 11th century. Although it was first used for fireworks and as an incendiary substance on arrows, it soon gained popularity in weapons. The Wujing Zongyao, a military manual from early 11th century China, was the first to conceptualise various kinds of military weapons like "flying incendiary club for subjugating demons," "ten-thousand fire flying sand magic bomb," "burning heaven fierce fire unstoppable bomb," and more outlandish plans, most of which eventually boiled down to basic firearms, cannons, bombs, etc.

One of the earliest ancestors of the modern gun was the fire lance. While initially it was nothing more than a little pyrotechnics attached to a typical spear for shock value, as gunpowder improved and the explosion became more powerful, pellets and shrapnel were added. In 1259 a pellet wad that occluded the barrel was recorded to have been used as a fire lance projectile, making it the first recorded bullet in history. Refinements to the fire lance formed the basic principle of a gun's structure that comprised of three parts: a metal barrel, gunpowder with high nitrate content, and a projectile that fills the muzzle completely so that the gunpowder charge can exert maximum force during propulsion.

The same concept was applied to cannons, and then hand cannons. And ever since then, right up to the modern gun, it's all the same principle at work.

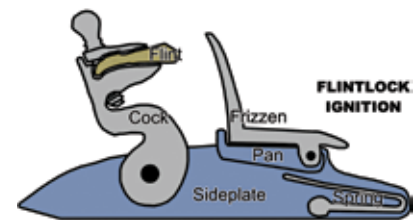
FIRE IN THE HOLE

For the next few centuries, the main focus was on finding ways to reliably, and efficiently light the gunpowder, along with improving repeat rates and accuracy. If you've heard the phrase "lock, stock and barrel", that comes from the three components of early guns – the barrel), the stock (which was used to support the gun

against the torso), and the lock, which was the device used to ignite the gunpowder. The first gun to bring all three together was a matchlock gun, in the early 14th century.

BETTER, FASTER, STRONGER

After match lighters came the flintlock system, which used flint to create sparks to ignite gunpowder. Shot accuracy was increased by the addition of grooves inside the barrel, which led to muskets, or rifles. Next, the percussion system offered significant advantages over the flintlock system by dropping the cumbersome powder,



The flintlock mechanism

and using a much easier cap-based system. Eventually, breechloaders dropped the front loading method altogether, and we ended up with almost modern looking guns.

Samuel Colt came up with the rotating cylinder with multiple chambers that would align a fresh cartridge when the hammer was cocked, and the revolver was born.



An early matchlock gun